



US Housing
CONSULTANTS

NSPIRE STANDARDS & PROTOCOLS

2023

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Understanding NSPIRE Standards

1 — Last update: 19 February 2026

US Housing Consultants

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- **Repair Due:** This is the number of days allotted for the repair to be completed. In some scenarios, the PBV/HCV repair timeframe is different, this is indicated with a "***" and a note at the bottom of the deficiency table
- **HCV Rating =** This is a Pass/Fail Rating. This term does not apply to any non-voucher program

Glossary of Other Terms:

- **HCV =** Housing Choice Vouchers
- **PBV =** Project-Based Vouchers
- **Common Areas:** This term refers to "Non-Unit" areas that are recorded in the "Inside" area on REAC Inspections. A "Common Area" is an interior or partially covered part of a building that is not used for dwelling – access to the public, or lack thereof, doesn't define whether an area is to be inspected.

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1.1. NSPIRE ACE Certification Course Description

US Housing Consultant's Understanding NSPIRE Accredited Compliance Expert (ACE) Course Description

US Housing Consultants full-day NSPIRE course covers this entire manual following the chapter outline and the live session includes additional resources and examples. The class begins at 9AM and the first 90 minute segment includes a breakdown of the origins of NSPIRE, the differences between UPCS, HQS, and NSPIRE. This includes a breakdown of the new severity ratings, the new pass or fail ratings, and the applicability of the rules for HCV, PBV, HUD CPD Programs, and REAC agency inspections from Multifamily Section 8, Public Housing, and LIHTC.

The course then reviews the procedures required to close out findings in REAC's new online system after REAC Inspections, and the expectations of close out procedures. We then will discuss new procedures for REAC Appeals, consequences for non-compliance, and new oversight processes from both HUD and REAC. Next, we'll discuss the REAC NSPIRE scoring methodology. We breakdown the formula used for scoring, and then explain how it works and show a number of examples and comparisons between the new scoring and the old system.

We review the NSPIRE standards following this manual as a guide, and then show how to understand the requirements and the underlying codes that much of these standards are based upon. (Timings are approximate)

1. 9AM – 10:30: Chapter 1 Review
 - a. NSPIRE Applicability
 - b. NSPIRE Background and Structure
 - c. Voucher Program Pass or Fail Ratings
 - d. Voucher Program LT Issues

Supportive Housing Program (SHP)	CPD	<u>24 CFR 583.300</u>	HQS
Housing Trust Fund	CPD	<u>24 CFR 93.301</u>	UPCS
Continuum of Care	CPD	<u>24 CFR 578.75</u>	HQS
Emergency Shelter Grants	CPD	<u>24 CFR 576.403</u>	HQS
Project-Based Section 8	Multifamily	<u>24 CFR 5</u>	UPCS
HUD FHA Financing	Multifamily	<u>24 CFR 200</u>	UPCS
Section 202/811	Multifamily	<u>24 CFR 800</u>	UPCS
Rural Housing 515/Section 8	Multifamily	<u>24 CFR 884.217</u>	UPCS
Section 8 HAP Program	Multifamily	<u>24 CFR 886</u>	UPCS
Public Housing	PIH	<u>24 CFR 902</u>	UPCS
Housing Choice Voucher	PIH	<u>24 CFR 982</u>	UPCS
Project-Based Vouchers	PIH	<u>24 CFR 98</u>	UPCS
Low-Income Housing Tax Credits	N/A	<u>24 CFR 5.703</u>	UPCS

- Added May 11, 2023 "HUD is removing from § 574.310(b) NSPIRE's applicability to housing for which HOPWA funds are used under permanent housing placement to pay an eligible person's security deposit, utility hookup, and processing costs, or move in costs, except rental application and credit check fees (§ 574.300(b)(7))."

Revision: 13 — Last modified: 18 June 2023

1.2.1. Implementation Dates

NSPIRE is to be implemented in two groups – one for Public and Indian Housing programs as of July 1, 2023, and the remaining programs will be effective as of 10/1/2023.

The following is a citation from the final notice published on 5/11/2023:

This rule has two effective dates:

1. Amendments to 24 CFR parts 5, 902, and 965 are effective on July 1, 2023. These amendments implement the NSPIRE regulations at 24 CFR part 5, subpart G, and affect the Public Housing regulations.
2. Amendments to 24 CFR parts 92, 93, 200, 570, 574, 576, 578, 882, 884, 886, 982, 983, and 985 are effective on October 1, 2023. These amendments affect the Multifamily Housing regulations, the Housing Choice Voucher regulations, the Project-Based Voucher regulations, Section 8 Moderate Rehabilitation regulations, and the Community Planning and Development (CPD) programs such as HOME Investment Partnerships Program (HOME), the Housing Trust Fund (HTF), Housing Opportunities for Persons with AIDS (HOPWA), Emergency Solution Grants (ESG) and Continuum of Care (COC)

NSPIRE rule until October 1, 2025.

This time should be used by participating jurisdictions and grantees to update property standard regulatory citations and requirements in written agreement templates with State recipients, sub-recipients, and project owners.

HTF grantees are advised to review the deficiencies established by NSPIRE and compare them to their existing rehabilitation and property standards, inspection procedures, and checklists.

HUD also reminds CoC, ESG, and HOPWA recipients who administer housing choice vouchers or project-based vouchers that they are permitted to adopt NSPIRE standards beginning October 1, 2023.

NSPIRE is genuinely designed for the inspection of multifamily assets and other rental units. Converting the standards for use on single-family homes and other structures may prove to be cumbersome. US Housing Consultants is well-prepared to help HOME and HTF programs update their policies and procedures to include NSPIRE standards during the year-long delay in full implementation. We are also preparing to offer specific HOME/HTF training once the new subset of NSPIRE standards is published in the Federal Register.

Revision: 3 --- Last modified: 1 October 2025

1.3. NSPIRE Fundamental Differences

There are numerous differences between NSPIRE and the predecessor inspection protocols – UPCS and HQS. Housing Quality Standards (HQS) were used for “Results Based” Inspections and UPCS Inspections were “Risk Based” inspections. A risk-based inspection takes a sampling of results and determines what risk may be present on the entire property and the owner’s general operation. REAC inspection used these risk ratings as a predictive indicator of whether or not there were likely more significant issues at a property. In comparison, HQS inspections were used to create a punch list for property owners of items that needed to be corrected to participate in a HUD-funded program.

The fundamental difference between those two approaches was what happens with the results of an inspection. For risk-based inspections, the risk rating dictated whatever next steps were to occur – which often included no follow-up if the risk was relatively low. Over the years, this approach has led to uneven results on REAC Inspections. In a 2018 Audit of REAC by the Office of the Inspector General, the auditors stated,

“We found that REAC could improve its inspection processes and controls related to the certification and monitoring of its contracted inspectors and its public housing units’ physical inspection processes. Specifically, REAC did not always ensure that (1) contract inspectors met requirements, (2) database system controls functioned properly, and (3) it verified the accuracy of sampled units for public housing authorities. These conditions occurred because REAC either did not follow its procedures or did not have procedures in place for parts of its inspection process. As a result, REAC did not always have the assurance that it (1) made the most effective and efficient use of its resources when training and certifying inspectors, (2) protected its database system data from unauthorized access and use, and (3) had accurate unit selections.”

Conversely, on HUD HQS Inspections, the results were the only thing that mattered, and the inspections

stairs, switches, walls, water heater, and windows.

Revision: 6 — Last modified: 10 July 2023

1.5. NSPIRE Severity Ratings

Each inspection standard and deficiency in NSPIRE includes a "Rating," which determines two factors – 1) The issue's possible impact on safety, and 2) whether or not the issue creates a life-threatening condition. Additionally, the ratings are used to determine the amount of time repairs are "due." The ratings used in this standard are:

Rating	Due Date
Life Threatening	24 Hours
Severe	24 Hours or 30 Days
Moderate	30 Days
Low	60 Days

Change to the name of § 5.711 (Update Published 5/11/2023)

HUD is renaming § 5.711 to more accurately reflect the purpose of this section. Changes to deficiency terminology at § 5.711© HUD is revising the different levels of deficiency to Life-Threatening (LT), Severe, Moderate, and Low. This change is reflected in the proposed NSPIRE Standards notice, and HUD is also amending § 5.709(a)(2)(i) for consistency with this change... HUD requires that Low deficiencies be repaired within sixty days unless specified otherwise in the NSPIRE Standards.

Rating	Description
Life-Threatening	The Life-Threatening category includes deficiencies that, if evident in the home or on the property, present a high risk of death to a resident.
Severe	The Severe category includes deficiencies that, if evident in the home or on the property, present a high risk of permanent disability, or serious injury or illness, to a resident; or the physical security or safety of a resident or their property would be seriously compromised.
Moderate	The Moderate Health and Safety category includes deficiencies that, if evident in the home or on the property, present a moderate risk of an adverse medical event requiring a healthcare visit; cause temporary harm; or if left untreated, cause or worsen a chronic condition that may have long-lasting adverse health effects; or that the physical security or safety of a resident or their property could be compromised.
Low	Deficiencies critical to habitability but not presenting a substantive health or safety risk to residents.

Revision: 8 — Last modified: 18 June 2023

Inspectable Item	Deficiency
Carbon Monoxide Alarm	Carbon monoxide alarm does not produce an audio or visual alarm when tested.
Chimney	A visually accessible chimney, flue, or firebox connected to a fireplace or wood-burning appliance is incomplete or damaged.
Chimney	Chimney exhibits signs of structural failure.
Dryer Exhaust	Electric dryer transition duct is detached or missing.
Dryer Exhaust	Gas dryer transition duct is detached or missing.
Dryer Exhaust	Electric dryer exhaust ventilation system has restricted airflow.
Dryer Exhaust	Dryer transition duct is constructed of unsuitable material.
Dryer Exhaust	Gas dryer exhaust ventilation system has restricted airflow.
Door – Entry	Entry door is missing.
Door – Fire Labeled	Fire labeled door is missing.
Egress	Obstructed means of egress
Egress	Sleeping Room on 3rd Floor or Below has Obstructed Rescue Opening
Egress	Fire Escape Is Obstructed
Electrical Conductors	Outlet or switch is damaged
Electrical Conductors	Exposed electrical conductor
Electrical Conductors	Water is currently in contact with an electrical conductor.
Electrical Panel	Overcurrent Protection Device Is Damaged
Exit Sign	Exit sign is damaged, missing, obstructed, or not adequately illuminated.
Fire Escape	Fire escape component is damaged or missing.
Fire Extinguisher	Fire extinguisher pressure gauge reads over or under-charged.
Fire Extinguisher	Fire extinguisher service tag is missing, illegible, or expired.
Fire Extinguisher	Fire extinguisher is damaged or missing.
Flammable Items	Flammable items within 3ft of an HVAC Appliance or Water Heater
Flammable Items	Improperly Stored Chemicals

1.6.3. Extension of NSPIRE Compliance Date for HCV Programs

HUD extended the compliance date for National Standards for the Physical Inspection of Real Estate (NSPIRE) final rule for Housing Choice Voucher (HCV) and Project Based Voucher (PBV) programs until February 1, 2027. NSPIRE was scheduled to go into effect October 1, 2023. [The full notice can be read here.](#)

HUD says it is taking this action to allow Public Housing Authorities (PHAs) additional time to implement HUD's NSPIRE standards.

Why The Extension for NSPIRE for Voucher Programs?

HUD says that additional time may be necessary for some PHAs to implement NSPIRE for HCV, PBV, and Moderate Rehabilitation (Mod Rehab) programs. If PHAs are not ready to implement NSPIRE now, they are encouraged to use the next 12 months to train staff and communicate with landlords. HUD says it will use the delay to provide additional technical resources needed for PHAs and agencies to transition to the NSPIRE standards. However, HUD encourages any PHA ready to implement NSPIRE at their earliest convenience.

What programs are included?

Under Housing Choice Vouchers, the included programs are:

- Emergency Housing Vouchers (EHV)
- Family Unification Program (FUP)
- Foster Youth to Independence (FYI) Initiative
- Mainstream Vouchers
- Non-Elderly Disabled (NED)
- Stability Voucher Program
- Tenant Protection Vouchers
- Veterans Affairs Supportive Housing (VASH) Vouchers
- Witness Relocation Program

Regarding Project-Based Vouchers:

Most Housing Choice Vouchers are "tenant-based," meaning people can use them to rent any private apartment that meets program guidelines. Project-based vouchers (PBV), in contrast, are attached to a specific unit whose landlord contracts with the state or local public housing agency to rent the unit to families and individuals with low incomes. These are included in this HUD NSPIRE notice.

1.7. Unit Sampling

The unit sampling methodology differentiates by funding program. NSPIRE does not designate unit sampling other than for inspections conducted by REAC. Properties inspected for Low-Income Housing Tax Credits, HOME, Housing Trust Fund, and other programs will follow the sampling methodology outlined in their monitoring standards.

Building Inspection Methods: Under NSPIRE, if a building does not contain any sampled units, the building will simply be excluded from the inspection.

Revision: 7 --- Last modified: 18 June 2023

1.7.1. REAC Sampling

Under NSPIRE, the unit sampling guidelines for HUD REAC Inspections. The sampling is based on a scale:

Units In Property	Sample	Units In Property	Sample
1	1	28-30	16
2	2	31-35	17
3	3	36-39	18
4	4	40-45	19
5	5	46-51	20
6	6	52-59	21
7	6	60-67	22
8	7	68-78	23
9	8	79-92	24
10	8	93-110	25
11-12	9	111-133	26
13-14	10	134-166	27
15-16	11	167-214	28
17-18	12	215-295	29
19-21	13	296-455	30
22-24	14	456-920	31
25-27	15	921+	32

Units In Property	Sample	Units In Property	Sample
2	2	35-40	16
3	3	41-47	17
4	4	48-56	18
5-6	5	57-67	19
7	6	68-81	20
8-9	7	82-101	21
10-11	8	102-130	22
12-13	9	131-175	23
14-16	10	176-257	24
17-18	11	258-449	25
19-21	12	450-1,461	26
22-25	13	1,462-9,999	27
26-29	14		

Revision: 11 — Last modified: 18 June 2023

1.7.4. HTF Unit Sampling

Inspections for properties funded with the Housing Trust Fund Program use their own sampling [NHTF 24 CFR 93.404\(d\)\(2\)\(V\)](#)

The regulations state:

Inspections must be based on a statistically valid sample of units appropriate for the size of the HTF-assisted project, as set forth by HUD through notice. The grantee must select the sample. For projects with one to four HTF-assisted units, the inspectable items (site, building exterior, building systems, and common areas) for each building with HTF-assisted units and 100 percent of the HTF-assisted dwelling units must be inspected.

Revision: 5 — Last modified: 18 June 2023

1.8. REAC Scoring with NSPIRE

Revision: 3 — Last modified: 28 November 2023

Area Rating Value x Number of Deficiencies ÷ 20 Unit Sample = Area Score

Severity Rating	Outside	Inside	Units
Life Threatening	$49.60 \times 0 \div 20 = 0$ Points	$54.50 \times 0 \div 20 = 0$ Points	$60.00 \times 3 \div 20 = 9$ Points
Severe	$12.20 \times 0 \div 20 = 0$ Points	$13.40 \times 0 \div 20 = 0$ Points	$14.80 \times 0 \div 20 = 0$ Points
Moderate	$4.50 \times 0 \div 20 = 0$ Points	$5.00 \times 5 \div 20 = 1.25$ Points	$5.50 \times 5 \div 20 = 1.375$ Points
Low	$2.00 \times 1 \div 20 = .1$ Points	$2.20 \times 10 \div 20 = 1.1$ Points	$2.40 \times 14 \div 20 = 1.68$ Points
Deduction	(.1) Points	(1.4) Points	(12.06) Points

Total Points Deducted From 100: $12.06 + 1.4 + .1 = 13.56$

Final Score 86

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1.8.4. Failing Unit Score Adjustment

As part of the NSPIRE changes, if more than 30 total points are lost in dwelling units, the score will automatically receive a failing score of the lesser of the actual score or 59. In the example below, this adjustment can be seen.

For each of the 12 sections above, the score is arrived at with the following equation:

(Area Severity Rating Value) * (Total Number of Deficiencies) ÷ (Unit Sample)

The following is an example of NSPIRE scoring.

- The sample property has 80 total units, with a sample of 20 units.
- At this property, a total of 30 deficiencies would result in the following score:

Area Rating Value x Number of Deficiencies ÷ 20 Unit Sample = Area Score

Severity Rating	Outside	Inside	Units
Life Threatening	$49.60 \times 0 \div 20 = 0$ Points	$54.50 \times 0 \div 20 = 0$ Points	$60.00 \times 8 \div 20 = 24$ Points
Severe	$12.20 \times 0 \div 20 = 0$ Points	$13.40 \times 0 \div 20 = 0$ Points	$14.80 \times 5 \div 20 = 3.70$ Points
Moderate	$4.50 \times 0 \div 20 = 0$ Points	$5.00 \times 5 \div 20 = 1.25$ Points	$5.50 \times 5 \div 20 = 1.375$ Points
Low	$2.00 \times 1 \div 20 = .225$ Points	$2.20 \times 10 \div 20 = 1.1$ Points	$2.40 \times 14 \div 20 = 1.68$ Points
Deduction	(.1) Points	(1.4) Points	• Points *

Total Points Deducted: $.1 + 1.4 + .3076 = 32.26$

edges, and infestation. This revision takes into consideration concerns expressed in public comments while upholding HUD's focus on resident health and safety as standards for acceptable living conditions.

Revision: 1 — Last modified: 21 July 2023

1.8.5.2. Delayed Scoring Deficiencies

The NSPIRE standards include a number of new design requirements. These items will not be scored for at least the first year of NSPIRE (expiring 10/1/2026). Repairs will be required if cited on an inspection, so the delay in scoring should not be perceived as a delay in the need to comply with the new requirements.

1. All fire-labeled door defects
2. All guardrail defects
3. Electrical – GFCI “An unprotected outlet is present within 6 feet of a water source.”
4. HVAC – “The inspection date is on or between October 1 and March 31, and the permanently installed heating source is working, and the interior temperature is 64 to 67.9 degrees Fahrenheit.
5. HVAC – The inspection date is on or between October 1 and March 31, and the permanently installed heating source is not working, or the permanently installed heating source is working, and the interior temperature is below 64 degrees Fahrenheit.
6. HVAC: “The inspection date is on or between April 1 and September 30 and a permanently installed heating source is damaged, inoperable, missing, or not installed.”
7. Interior Lighting: “At least one (1) permanently installed light fixture is not present in the kitchen and bathroom.”
8. Minimum Electrical and Lighting: “At least two (2) working outlets are not present within each habitable room OR At least one (1) working outlet and one (1) permanently installed light fixture is not present within each habitable room.”

Revision: 2 — Last modified: 17 February 2026

1.8.5.3. Affirmative Habitability Requirements

TABLE 64—AFFIRMATIVE HABITABILITY REQUIREMENTS

Inspectable Item	Location	Deficiency
Bathtub and Shower	Unit	Bathtub or shower cannot be used in private.
Cabinet and Storage	Unit	Food storage space is not present.
Carbon Monoxide	Unit	Carbon monoxide alarm is missing, not installed, or not installed in a proper location.

Inspectable Item	Location	Deficiency
Smoke Alarm	Inside	Smoke alarm is not installed where required.
Toilet	Unit	Toilet cannot be used in private.

Revision: 1 — Last modified: 17 June 2023

1.9. Annual Self-Inspections

As part of the NSPIRE update, HUD Multifamily Programs will now be subject to the same requirements as Public Housing, which requires that all units be subject to annual inspection.

Per the final NSPIRE notice. Section 5.707 Uniform self-inspection requirement and report.

All PHAs and owners of HUD housing subject to an assistance contract, other than owners participating in the HCV, PBV, and programs, are required to annually self-inspect their properties, including all units, to ensure the units are maintained in accordance with the standards in § 5.703. The owner or PHA must maintain the results of such self-inspections for three years and must provide the results to HUD upon request. This self-inspection is independent of other HUD inspections discussed in § 5.705. The owner or PHA may choose to conduct this inspection after a HUD inspection to satisfy this requirement and the post-report survey requirement at § 5.711©(2) simultaneously.

Full Self-Inspections After a Failing REAC Score

HUD is also adding a requirement that properties that score below 60 must complete a full self-inspection and not the limited self-inspection described in this regulation for identified deficiencies in units and areas of the property not inspected by REAC. This addition is necessary to ensure that owners and PHAs survey 100 percent of their properties when they have poor physical performance (i.e., scores below 60) in order to identify additional health and safety defects in the units that were not part of the inspection sample. PHAs and owners that conduct a full inspection after the HUD inspection can consider this inspection to satisfy the requirements of § 5.707 for that year.

Revision: 2 — Last modified: 18 June 2023

1.9.1. Post Survey Requirements

As part of the scoring notice update, HUD has included a new requirement that at the end of each REAC Inspection, the property must do a full inspection of its own and then report the findings and repair records to HUD.

"Completion of a Post-report Survey: At the completion of a REAC inspection, the owner or PHA must review the inspection report and perform a survey of units not inspected and provide that information to HUD. For properties that scored at or above 60, the survey may be limited to inspecting for deficiencies

2. Fire and Life Safety

Revision: 1 — Last modified: 3 April 2023

2.1. Call for Aid System

A resident uses a call-for-aid system to summon aid during a medical emergency. They can come in the form of a system that alerts an external emergency response source, or an internal notification system, typically with alarms and lights. These systems are not required under this inspection protocol. Still, if they are present, they must be tested to determine if the system is functional and if the elements of the system (a cord, lights, annunciators, etc.) are operating as intended.

- The call-for-aid cord must hang six or fewer inches from the floor.
- If the call-for-aid alarm system includes a light in the hallway, it must be tested to ensure that it operates as intended.
- The call-for-aid cord must not be coiled or tied up/off.
- Not all call-for-aid systems will have a cord, some may have a button, which should not be cited as an issue.
- The annunciator panel is a centralized panel that indicates which apartment/room an emergency call originates from. To test, the inspector should have a property representative at the panel and communicate with them via cellular phone or other devices to determine if the corresponding light is illuminating during a unit or common area inspection.
- Personal wireless call-for-aid systems, typically worn around a resident's neck, are not to be inspected.

Abandoned Systems

- If the call-for-aid system is abandoned: Do not evaluate call-for-aid systems if all pull stations have been removed; all that remains are the indicator lights, audible indicators, or annunciator panels. The primary consideration is that no part of the user interface remains.

Offsite Monitored Systems

- If monitored offsite, request the owner/agent either
- Notify the site monitor and ask them to put the system on test.
- Provide third-party documentation of a call-for-aid inspection.

If the property is able to provide documentation for a call-for-aid inspection, then:

- The inspector does not need to test all pull stations.
- Verify that the document addresses all parts of the call-for-aid system.
- If a valid or certified third-party inspection has been completed in the last 12 months of inspection, do not test the call-for-aid interface.

*Wireless call-for-aid systems typically worn around a resident's neck are not to be inspected.

- On every level of a dwelling unit, and

As of June 11, 2024, these two deficiencies were now stated to be a recommendation only and are not a "requirement". See the [update notice](#) here on our website.

- "Not" within 10 feet of a cooking appliance;
- "Not" within Three feet of Ceiling Fans, Air Ducts, Exterior Doors, or Windows

Smoke detectors do not have to be hard-wired, and there are no design requirements for the type of alarm used at a property. However, there are specifications as to the location of each smoke alarm on a wall or ceiling:

- If mounted on the ceiling, it must be more than 4 inches from the wall.
- It cannot be closer than 4 inches or more than 12 inches from the ceiling if mounted on the wall measured from the top of the smoke detector.
- Smoke alarms should not be installed within 36" of windows, exterior doors, or ducts where drafts might interfere with their operation.
- Smoke alarms should not be painted or have stickers or other decorations present.

During an inspection, each smoke alarm should be physically tested to ensure the device tests as intended. If the property cannot demonstrate that the device works properly, it should be cited as inoperable.

As of December 29, 2024, all smoke detectors which are solely battery-operated will have to have sealed, tamper-proof batteries. It will not be an NSPIRE deficiency until that time.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Smoke alarm not installed in a sleeping room	Life Threatening	24-Hours	Fail
1	Smoke alarm not installed within 21' of bedroom door	Life Threatening	24-Hours	Fail
1	Each level of a unit does not have at least one smoke alarm	Life Threatening	24-Hours	Fail
1	Any level of a Building missing at least one smoke alarm in the common area	Life Threatening	24-Hours	Fail
1	Ceiling-mounted smoke alarm less than 4in. from a wall	Life Threatening	24-Hours	Fail
1	Wall-mounted smoke alarm within 4in. of a ceiling	Life Threatening	24-Hours	Fail
1	Wall-mounted smoke alarm more than 12in. from a ceiling	Life	24-Hours	Fail

requirements concerning carbon monoxide detection._

The standards for CO alarm and detection in this protocol are based on Chapters 9 and 11 of the 2018 International Fire Code (IFC) publication published by the International Code Council (ICC). Where NPSIRE is non-specific (e.g., design, installation, type of equipment), ICC and IBC would be the governing standard unless the local code is more stringent. The essentials of these codes are listed below.

1. "Carbon Monoxide Detection shall be installed in dwelling units containing a fuel-burning appliance or a fireplace." IFC – Chapter 9, Section 915.1.2 – Locations
2. "Carbon Monoxide detection shall be included in any dwelling units with attached private garages" IFC, Chapter 9, Section 915.1.5 Private Garages.
3. "Carbon Monoxide detectors shall be installed in dwelling units outside each sleeping area and in the immediate vicinity of the bedroom. If a fuel-burning appliance is installed in the bedroom, a CO detector must be installed in the bedroom" Section 915.2.1.
4. If a fuel-burning appliance is located in an attic, then treat the attic space as a mechanical room.

What Kind of CO Alarms are Required, and Where Do They Need to be Installed?

1. Carbon Monoxide detectors shall receive their primary power from the building's wiring. When the primary power service is interrupted, they are serviced by a battery (i.e., a detector must be hard-wired and have a battery backup). Section 915.4.1 Power Source
2. The exception to Hard-Wiring: ICC Chapter 11 – 1103.09 Carbon Monoxide Alarms can be exclusively battery operated where the code in effect at the time of construction did not require carbon monoxide detectors to be provided.
3. The CO alarms must meet the UL 2034 standard for sensitivity and UL 217. When purchasing CO alarms, ensure they meet these standards for sensitivity. Combination smoke and CO alarms must comply with UL2075 and UL268.
4. IFC does not specify where CO detectors should be installed. Installation should follow the manufacturer's specifications. If no specifications can be located, the best practice is to install CO detectors approximately 5' from the floor and not within 6" of a conjoining wall. If wall placement is not feasible, place them on the ceiling no less than 6" from any wall. If the CO alarm is combined with a smoke alarm, follow the correct smoke alarm placement.

Common Examples of Housing Layout Scenarios and Their Need for CO Alarms

1. Does the unit have fuel-burning appliances, HVAC, or Domestic Hot Water Equipment located inside the unit?
 - a. Yes, the unit must have CO Alarms/Detectors.
2. Does the unit have an attached enclosed garage (i.e., does not have open walls)?
 - a. Yes, the unit must have CO Alarms/Detectors.
3. Does the unit have a central heating system that consists of gas-fired forced hot air distributed into the unit by a furnace and ductwork?
 - a. Yes, the unit must have CO Alarms/Detectors.
4. Does the unit have a central (i.e., not in the unit) fuel-fired forced hot water (i.e., steam or hot water) system for heating, no gas appliances, and no attached garage?

Carbon Monoxide Alarm Standard V3.0, Updated 8/11/23

Revision: 19 — Last modified: 15 August 2023

2.4. Auxiliary Lights

Some buildings are equipped with emergency power lighting, also known as auxiliary lighting. There is no requirement for these fixtures to be installed under this inspection protocol; however, if they are installed, they must meet the following standards:

- The auxiliary lighting needs to remain functional when tested.
- Determine if the mounting bracket is intact and free of damage.
- Determine if evidence indicates a component was installed but is missing during the inspection.
- Is the auxiliary lighting fixture damaged and hanging loose from its mount? (i.e., it is not securely mounted).
- If the component is both an exit sign and an auxiliary light, any conditions should be cited separately under each item's standards.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Auxiliary lighting component fails to illuminate when tested	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
1	Auxiliary lighting component is damaged or missing	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
1	Auxiliary lighting mounting bracket is damaged	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
1	Auxiliary lighting component is hanging loose from mounting	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail

**PBV/HCV Correction Timeline is 30 Days for this Deficiency

Lighting – Auxiliary Standard V3.0, Updated 6/16/23

Lighting – Auxiliary Standard V3.0, Updated 8/11/23

Revision: 11 — Last modified: 15 August 2023

2.5. Fire Sprinkler Assembly

The building's fire protection sprinkler system is inspected on buildings where these systems are present. There is no requirement under this standard for any building to have a sprinkler system, only that the systems are free from signs of damage. The standard includes an evaluation of four elements:

- Obstruction of sprinkler heads.
- Foreign materials such as dust, rust, corrosion, and paint are on sprinkler heads.
- Sprinkler escutcheon rings that are missing where they are intended to be installed.
- Concealed sprinkler head covers that are glued or caulked to the ceiling.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Fire extinguisher pressure gauge reads over- or under-charged	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	The date on the fire extinguisher service tag has exceeded one year (Expired)	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	The fire extinguisher tag is missing or illegible	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	A nonchargeable or disposable fire extinguisher is more than 12 years old (based on manufacture date)	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
3	Fire extinguisher is damaged	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
3	Fire extinguisher is missing	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail

Fire Extinguisher Standard V3.0. Updated 6/16/23



Resident Owned Fire Extinguishers Should Not Be Inspected

Revision: 7 — Last modified: 18 June 2023

2.7. Exit Signs

Under these standards, exit signs are not required to be installed in a building based on its design, location, age, or other characteristics. Additionally, there are no requirements for what type of sign is used, where they are installed, and the consistency of use in a building (e.g., at every door, etc.). The function of lighted exit signs is to allow you to find the exit or emergency egress route in an emergency and provide better visibility in a fire situation. The standards for exit signs include the following conditions:

- Missing: The sign must be fully intact and functional if evidence exists of a previously installed sign or sign components.
- The exit sign must be firmly mounted and in good condition.
- The word "EXIT" must be legible and visible (i.e., not blocked by any object)
- The exit sign has to be adequately illuminated. * If a test button is present, engage the test button and verify that the battery-powered backup light comes on. – If there is no test button, verify that the AC-powered sign is fully lit.
- Some AC-powered signs may have unutilized test buttons, and some backup batteries may be remotely located.
- Combination auxiliary light and exit sign devices must be recorded as two deficiencies, each within

3. Bathroom/Laundry

Revision: 1 — Last modified: 3 April 2023

3.1. Bathroom Exhaust Fan

Some form of ventilation is required in all restrooms and bathrooms. Ventilation can consist of a window, a passive vent, or a motorized exhaust fan. To test the ventilation in the bathroom, the following steps should be followed:

- Open the restroom/bathroom window if one exists, and ensure that the window will remain open.
- For ceiling or wall ventilation, turn the fan on, unless it is a passive system or sensor-controlled, and apply a single piece of toilet paper to the vent grill and ensure that the tissue paper adheres to the grill from the suction.
- The owner/agent is allowed to plug in an exhaust fan if it is present and unplugged
- The bathroom vent should not be cited as malfunctioning or inoperable if the owner/agent indicates that the component is connected to a timer or is sensor controlled.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Exhaust system does not respond to the control switch.	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	Exhaust system has restricted airflow	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
3	Exhaust system component is damaged or missing	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
4	Bathroom missing an installed exhaust system or ventilation window	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
4	Bathroom ventilation system is inoperable	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

Ventilation Standard V3.0. Updated 6/16/23

Ventilation Standard V3.0. Updated 8/11/23

Revision: 13 — Last modified: 27 November 2023

3.2. Bathroom & Laundry Cabinets

There is no requirement to have cabinetry in laundry rooms or restrooms in dwelling units or common areas. The standards outlined for cabinetry and countertops are included under the same section as kitchen cabinetry; the exception is that there is no standard for "missing" cabinets under bathroom and laundry areas.

All elements should be inspected when evaluating cabinets, including doors, drawers, hinges, knobs,

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Unit Sink or sink component is damaged or missing (affects functionality)	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
1	Common Area Sink or sink component is damaged or missing (affects functionality)	Low	60 Days	Pass
2	Water is directed outside of the basin	Low	60 Days	Pass
3	Sink is clogged/not draining	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
4	Sink is improperly installed, leaning, or pulling away from wall	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
4	There are gaps between the sink and wall	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
5	Sink or sink component is damaged or missing (Minor)	Low	60 Days	Pass
5	Sink stopper missing or inoperable	Low	60 Days	Pass
6	Control knobs do not activate or deactivate hot and cold water	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

Sink Standard V3.0. Updated 6/16/23

Sink Standard V3.0. Updated 8/11/23

Revision: 14 — Last modified: 15 August 2023

3.4. Toilets

Restrooms and bathrooms are required to have a functional toilet. To determine if the toilet is operating as intended, test the toilet by following these steps:

1. Open the toilet seat and lid.
 2. Lightly apply pressure to the side of the toilet and ensure that it does not move on the floor. This can be done by pushing softly with a knee, straddling the toilet, and attempting to move the basin.
 3. Flush the toilet and ensure that the toilet properly drains and refills and stops running after refilling the tank.
- Inspect the toilet for any damaged or missing components, such as a damaged seat, flush handles, lids, or other components.

Explanation of terms in deficiency table:

- Missing: Bathrooms and Restrooms must have a toilet. The deficiencies below for a "missing" toilet refer to evidence that a toilet was previously installed and has been removed or that a bathroom exists where no toilet is in the room or immediate vicinity.
- "Only Toilet in Unit" – this terminology is used to determine the rating and repair timeframe. A lesser rating is applied to missing or damaged toilets if another functioning toilet is present in the unit.

3.5.1. Unit Showers/Bathtubs

Showers and Bathtubs are required in dwelling units unless the unit is a SRO or equivalent unit where the shower facilities are centrally located. In those cases, the centrally located shower should be inspected as part of the dwelling unit.

- The inspector should determine the proper functionality of a shower or bathtub by engaging all of the elements and observing its function.
- If the bathtub has a stopper or pop-up assembly, engage the stopper and turn on the water supply (e.g., faucet or shower head) and let the water run for 30-45 seconds so water fills the basin.
- Watch the water level and ensure that the bathtub stopper or assembly appropriately holds the water and prevents drainage while water is being held in the basin. If water is being held appropriately, release the stopper.
- Check the lower faucet and ensure that there are no leaks around the faucet.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Bath/shower inoperable or not draining (only bath in unit)	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
2	Bath/Shower inoperable/not draining (another bath present)	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
3	Bath/shower components damaged, missing, or inoperable	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
3	Bath/shower valve is damaged, missing, or inoperable	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
3	Bath/shower pan or basin damaged, missing, or inoperable	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
4	Bath/shower basin discolored on more than 50% of surface	Low	60 Days	Pass
4	Bath/shower stopper damaged, missing, or inoperable	Low	60 Days	Pass
4	Bath/shower curtain/door damaged, missing, or inoperable	Low	60 Days	Pass
5	Bathtub or shower cannot be used in private	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

**PBV/HCV Correction Timeline is 30 Days for this Deficiency

Bathtub and Shower Standard V3.0, Updated 6/16/23

Bathtub and Shower Standard V3.0, Updated 8/11/23

Revision: 11 — Last modified: 15 August 2023

3.5.2. Common Area Showers/Bathtubs

Showers and Bathtubs in non-unit locations do not include any centrally located showers or bathtubs such as in group homes or SROs where the showers/bathtubs are shared facilities. In those cases, the showers/bathtubs should be associated with a sampled unit.

bathroom. All other handrails must be inspected using the Handrail standard.

Grab Bar Standard V2.2 Updated 6/23/22

Revision: 8 — Last modified: 18 June 2023



Deficiency # 1 refers to both a requirement for a kitchen to have storage cabinets and any evidence of any cabinets being entirely removed – not just components such as doors, drawers, etc

Revision: 22 — Last modified: 29 August 2023

4.2. Kitchen Countertops

Countertops are flat surface installations in kitchens or food preparation spaces that are generally used for food preparation and are made of nonporous surfaces that are designed to be cleaned. Kitchen countertops should be inspected for wear and tear, which may be indicated by swelling, delamination, scratches, cuts, burns, peeling, or missing laminate. The countertop should also be inspected to ensure it is properly secured to the wall and base cabinetry.

The countertop in the kitchen is evaluated for physical damage. It should be cited if the damage exceeds 10% of the counter area or if there is evidence that a countertop was previously installed but is now not present or is incomplete.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Food preparation area is not present.	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	10%+ or more of the Countertop is damaged or has exposed substrate	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	The entire kitchen countertop is not adequate (in either size or function)	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

Kitchen Countertop Standard V3.0. Updated 6/16/23

Kitchen Countertop Standard V3.0. Updated 8/11/23



The food preparation area is not functionally adequate if it does not reasonably allow for adequate preparation of food or if the surface cannot be sanitized.

Revision: 20 — Last modified: 15 August 2023

4.3. Kitchen Sinks

Sinks are inspected to determine if the faucet and other hardware operate as intended. This includes evaluating how the sink is installed, how it is attached to the wall or countertop, and whether it is properly mounted. An inspection of a sink includes a review of the following:

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Refrigerator is inoperable	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	Refrigerator door seal is damaged	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	Refrigerator door handle is damaged	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	Refrigerator drawers or shelving is damaged	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	Refrigerator interior lining is damaged	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
3	Refrigerator is missing	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

Refrigerator Standard V3.0, Updated 6/16/23

Revision: 12 — Last modified: 27 November 2023

4.5. Cooking Appliances

1. Do all the heating elements on the stove or range produce heat and properly regulate the heat?
 - a. This includes all range burners, broilers, and bake elements on a range/stove.
 - b. To determine if range elements are properly regulating heat, look for conditions such as whether or not the burners are fully lit around the entire ring of the burner and if the entire oven element is lit.
 - c. For gas ranges, ensure that flames are equally aligned around the burner.
 - d. To completely test heat regulation, the oven should be thoroughly heated to 350 degrees and determine if the heat is maintained after several minutes with a temperature testing device.
2. Are all components of the range or stove in place and working condition?
 - a. This includes baking or burner elements, grates, racks, knobs, the ignition system, a convection fan, door hinges, door seals, handles, lights, the light fixture(s) in the oven, the drip pan, and glass surfaces.
3. Is the primary cooking device missing?
 - a. Dwelling units must have a primary cooking device unless the unit is an SRO (single residential unit) with a shared kitchen. The primary cooking device can be considered a microwave if it is the only device in the kitchen.
 - b. Look for evidence of the prior installation of an appliance, such as a vacant 220-volt outlet, gas line, or open section between base cabinets.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	The oven is not producing heat	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
1	No burner on the cooking range or cooktop produces heat.	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail

Revision: 9 — Last modified: 15 August 2023

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Ceiling has an unstable surface	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
1	Ceiling has signs of structural failure (cracking, small circles, blisters, or nail pops)	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	Ceiling has a hole that opens directly to the outside environment	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	Ceiling has a hole 2in. or more in diameter	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
3	Ceiling has sagging or dropping materials	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
3	Ceiling component(s) is not functionally adequate	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail

**HCV/PBV Correction Timeframe for this standard is 30 Days

Ceiling Standard V3.0. Updated 8/11/23

Revision: 12 — Last modified: 9 December 2023

5.3. Wall Covering and Finishes

A wall covering is a vertical surface that may define an area and provide security, shelter, or soundproofing. The surface provides a vertical separation between rooms or spaces and may provide security or privacy, soundproofing, climate control, and fire protection. This section includes wall and ceiling coverings and finishes, including drywall, plaster, baseboards, and molding. The standard is focused on two primary deficiencies – (1) holes and (2) bulging or buckling/unstable surfaces. Cosmetic issues such as peeling paint are not included under this standard. If there are possible lead-based paint hazards, they should be evaluated under the lead paint standards.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Wall has a loose or detached surface covering	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	Wall is buckling, bulging, or bowing	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	Interior wall component(s) is not functionally adequate	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
3	Interior wall has hole greater than 2in.	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
3	Interior wall has holes affecting an area greater than 6x6in.	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

Wall Covering and Finish Standard V3.0 Updated 6/16/23

Revision: 8 — Last modified: 18 July 2023

section, pushing and pulling rapidly to determine if there is movement at the guardrail anchor or fastener.

Guardrails should be installed for elevated walkways used by the general public and wherever guardrails were previously installed. Secure roof areas are not required to have guardrails if they have never been installed previously and the area has restricted access. If the roof is readily accessible to the public, guardrails will be required.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Guardrail is missing on an elevated (30in. or more) walking surface	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	Guardrail is damaged	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	Guardrail is less than 30in.	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	Guardrail not secure and cannot protect from falling	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	Guardrail is missing a functional component	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail

Guardrail Standard V3.0 Updated 8/11/23

* A functional component (e.g., top rail, base rail, post, baluster, or picket) is one that is critical to the guardrail protecting from fall hazards. A decorative or ornamental component (e.g., post cap) should not be evaluated under this defect.

Revision: 22 — Last modified: 9 December 2023

5.6. Handrails

Handrails are defined as rail that is fixed to a post or a wall used for stability or support. Handrails are commonly used in ascending or descending stairways and escalators to prevent injurious falls. There are several conditions included in this standard:

1. Missing: missing is defined as several scenarios:
 - a. A ramp has a rise of more than 6" or a horizontal projection greater than 72" (six feet) and does not have a railing present that is at least 28" from the surface and not more than 42" on both sides of the ramp.
 - b. In accordance with UFAS 4.8.5, Curb Ramps should not be included in this requirement, even if the run length is 6 feet or more on the curb ramp.

6. Lighting and Electrical

Revision: 1 — Last modified: 3 April 2023

6.1. Conductors, Outlets, Switches

This standard relates to any exposed electrical conductor that presents a hazard. This includes an electrical conductor that is not enclosed or properly insulated (e.g., damaged sheathing, open port, missing knockout, missing outlet or switch cover, missing breaker or fuse, or a missing lightbulb) or an opening or gap is present and measures greater than 1/2 inch.

- This standard does not include low-voltage wires.
- Whether or not these connections are behind a locked door is not a factor in this inspection.
- These conditions should be cited regardless of who has access to a room where the wiring is located.
- If the manufacturer intentionally designs a device with a gap or space to support ventilation, it should not be evaluated under this standard.
- If a lightbulb is missing from a fixture, then it should be evaluated under the Lighting Standards

Example conductors to be evaluated under this deficiency include but are not limited to:
Knockouts.

- Device cover plates that are missing (i.e., evidence of prior installation but are now missing or incomplete).
- Device cover plates that are damaged (i.e., visibly defective; impacts functionality).
- Lighting fixtures
- Hardwired smoke alarms.
- Visible wire nuts on electrical conductors.
- Wiring that is insulated but not protected by sheathing or conduit.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Outlet or switch is damaged	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	Improperly wired or grounded outlet	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
3	Electric outlet inoperable (no visible damage)	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
4	Exposed electrical conductor	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
4	Gap of 1/2"+ in any high-voltage electrical apparatus	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
4	Electrical conductor is not properly insulated/enclosed	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
5	Water is currently in contact with an electrical conductor	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail

**HCV/PBV Correction Timeframe for this standard is 30 Days

6.3. Electric Service Panels

Electric service panels are in enclosures, cabinets, boxes, or panel boards containing overcurrent protection devices for controlling light, heat, appliances, and power circuits. This standard refers to three conditions related to electric service panels:

- Obstructed panels on the interior, exterior, or dwelling units.
- Damage to breakers or fuses in the form of rust or corrosion.
- Damage to breakers or fuses in the form of melted parts, burns, arcing, or smoke damage.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Electric service panel is obstructed and not readily accessible	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	A fuse or breaker is physically damaged (melted, arcing scars, burns, or smoke damage)	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
3	A fuse or breaker is contaminated; either water, rust or corrosion	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail

**PBV/HCV Correction Timeframe for this Deficiency is 30 Days

Electrical – Service Panel Standard V3.0 Updated 6/16/23

Electrical – Service Panel Standard V3.0 Updated 8/11/23



An electrical conductor that is not enclosed or properly insulated should be evaluated under the Electrical – Conductor standard.

Revision: 14 — Last modified: 15 August 2023

6.4. Min. Electrical & Lighting

This standard outlines a requirement to have a minimum amount of electrical receptacles and/or lighting in habitable rooms. This standard only applies to dwelling units and should not be applied to common area locations or anything outside.

This standard is a carry over from HQS and is rooted in NEC 210.70 Lighting Outlets Required

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Habitable rooms missing 2+ Outlets or 1 Outlet/1 Light Fixture	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	A permanently installed light fixture is inoperable	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	A permanently installed light fixture is not secure	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
3	A kitchen or bathroom is missing a permanently installed light fixture	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

Lighting – Interior Standard V3.0 Updated 6/16/23

Lighting – Interior Standard V3.0 Updated 8/11/23

Revision: 16 — Last modified: 15 August 2023

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
3	A unit window will not close	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
4	A unit window weather stripping or seal is damaged or missing	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
4	A unit window pane, sash, or frame is damaged or missing	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
4	A unit window is damaged or missing affecting illumination or protection from the elements	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
4	A unit window screen has a hole, tear, or cut of more than one inch	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

**HCV/PBV Repair Timeframe is 30 Days for this Deficiency

Windows Standard Updated 8/11/23

* Issues with Blocked Access to Windows Should be Cited Under "Hazards – Egress"

Revision: 12 — Last modified: 9 December 2023

7.1.2. Common Area Windows

Windows are inspected on the interior of the building in both the units and common areas. The windows are inspected to determine if they function as intended, which relates to their ability to open, close, and lock. Additionally, the window's elements relate to the physical structure, including the frame, sill, seal, weather stripping, and screens. For this inspection, all of these elements are included in the standard. However, the elements related to functionality, such as the ability to open, close, and lock, are given more weight, and windows in the dwelling units are given a more severe rating than those in the common areas.

- Condensation that is present due to a failed window seal should not be evaluated.*

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	A common area window will not open or stay open	Low	60 Days	Pass
2	A common area window cannot be secured/locked	Low	60 Days	Pass
3	A common area window will not close	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

7.3. Entry Doors

The deficiencies of the “Entry Door Standard” have been divided into two categories for the purpose of this, as there are many different deficiencies for this one item, and dividing them into “Hardware” and “Surface” issues creates more manageable groups.

* If an Entry Door is Fire-Rated, It Should Be Inspected Under “Fire Labeled Doors”

Revision: 3 — Last modified: 19 June 2023

7.3.1. Entry Door Hardware

This standard refers to doors used for entry into units, common area rooms, and other locations where there is a presumption of privacy or security between locations (e.g., from the hallway into a unit but not within a unit). “Door hardware” refers to any equipment that is part of the operation of a door, including hinges, self-closing devices, and any other installed hardware.

The hardware on entry doors must be physically tested to ensure it functions as intended. This standard does not apply to any door with fire labeling on the door.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Entry door will not open	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	A Unit Entry door will not close	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
2	A Common Area Entry door will not close	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
3	Entry door self-closing mechanism is damaged, inoperable or missing	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
3	Entry door self-closing mechanism is missing (evidence of prior installation)	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
4	A Unit Entry door cannot be secured/locked	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
4	A Common Area Entry door cannot be secured/locked	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

**PBV/HCV Correction Timeline is 30 Days for this Deficiency

Door-Entry Standard Updated 8/11/23

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
7	The entry door frame, threshold or trim is damaged or missing	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
8	Entry door frame, threshold, or trim is damaged or missing	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
9	Gap of 1/4" around door seal/gasket & light penetration	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
9	Evidence of water penetration through damaged door seal	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
10	Entry door component is damaged, inoperable, or missing (does not affect privacy or security)	Low	60 Days	Pass

**PBV/HCV Repair Timeframe for this deficiency is 30 Days

Door-Entry Standard Updated 8/11/23

Revision: 19 — Last modified: 9 December 2023

7.4. General Doors

This standard relates to non-fire-rated and non-entry doors on the interior or exterior of the building. On the interior of the building, these are referred to as passage doors, and on the outside, they are referred to as exterior doors. The doors should be inspected to identify damaged, inoperable, or missing components.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	A passage door does not open	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	A passage door component is damaged/missing/inoperable	Low	60 Days	Pass
3	A closet door component is damaged/missing/inoperable	Low	60 Days	Pass
4	An exterior door component is damaged or missing (not entry door or fire rated)	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

Door – General Standard V3.0 Updated 8/11/23



This standard only applies to Non-Fire-Labeled and Non-Entry Doors

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
4	Fire-labeled door seal or gasket is damaged or missing	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
5	Fire-labeled door is held-open with an object	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
5	A fire-labeled door is blocked by an object	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
6	A unit fire-labeled door cannot be secured/locked	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
6	A common area fire-labeled door cannot be secured/locked	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
7	Fire-labeled door is missing (evidence of prior installation)	Life-Threatening	24 Hours	Fail

**PBV/HCV Correction Timeframe is 30 Days for this Deficiency

Door – Fire-Labeled Standard V3.0 Updated 8/11/23

Revision: 23 — Last modified: 4 March 2024

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Natural gas, propane, or oil leak	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
1	There is an uncapped gas or fuel supply line	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail

Leak- Gas/Oil Standard 6/16/23

Leak- Gas/Oil Standard 8/11/23

Revision: 5 — Last modified: 15 August 2023

8.3. Plumbing & Water Leaks

This standard relates to leaks in plumbing systems and leaks from HVAC and domestic hot water systems. This section includes the following:

1. Water leaks into a building from environmental issues.
 - a. Look for any leaking or discoloration.
 - b. Look for swelling window sills or moisture around the interior of windows or doors.
 - c. Look for deteriorating components on the ceiling or walls.
 - d. Examine the interior for cracks, failing window glazing, and anywhere else that water could intrude.
2. Leaks in plumbing systems.
 - a. Look for mold or mildew, peeling paint or wallpaper, a wall that is warped or stained for no apparent reason, or a buckled, cracked, or water-stained floor or ceiling.
 - b. Inspect all visible plumbing connections, including gas traps, supply lines, and direct connections to the fixture.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Environmental water intrusion	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	Plumbing leaks	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	Plumbing leak observed Outside	Low	60 Days	Pass
3	Fluid is leaking from a sprinkler assembly	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
3	Fluid is leaking from a sprinkler assembly Outside	Low	60 Days	Pass

Leak Standard V3.0 Updated 6/16/23



Any plumbing or environmental water leak should be cited with this standard. This includes evidence of leaks on ceilings, floors, walls, toilets, sinks, dishwashers, water heaters, central water supply, sewer lines, etc.

- Cross-linked polyethylene (PEX) plastic tubing
- Ductile iron
- Cross-linked polyethylene/aluminum/high-density – Polyethylene (PEX-AL-HDPE) pipe
- Polyethylene (PEX-AL-PEX) pipe
- Galvanized steel pipe
- Polyethylene/aluminum/ polyethylene (PE-AL-PE) pipe – Polypropylene (PP) plastic pipe or tubing
- Stainless steel pipe (type 304 or 316)

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Pressure relief valve or discharge pipe is obstructed	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
1	Pressure relief valve discharge piping is damaged	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
1	Pressure relief valve has an active leak	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
2	Hot water does not dispense from a faucet or other fixture	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
2	Common Area faucet does not dispense hot water	Low	60 Days	Pass
3	Pressure relief valve discharge piping is missing	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
3	Pressure relief valve terminates higher than 6" or less than 2" from the floor	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
3	Pressure relief valve is damaged, capped, has an upward slope, or is constructed of unsuitable material	Severe	24 Hours	Fail
4	Chimney or flue piping is blocked, misaligned, missing, or has a negative downward slope	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
5	Gas shutoff valve is damaged, missing, or not installed	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail

**PBV/HCV Correction Timeframe is 30 Days for this Deficiency

Water Heater Standard V2.2 Updated 6/23/22

Revision: 31 — Last modified: 11 April 2025

8.7. Heating and Cooling (HVAC)

Revision: 16 — Last modified: 29 June 2023

8.7.1. Min. HVAC Requirements

The heating and cooling system is inspected to determine if the equipment is safe and functional. There are three systems evaluated under this standard:

Heating: A system consisting of a heat source and method of distribution designed to heat the surrounding air and area.

- A permanently installed heating source is installed and self-fueled.
- A permanently installed heating source may include forced air heating, radiant heat, baseboard units heated by electric, or installed wall units.
- A permanently installed heating source may not include space heaters that are not installed or fireplaces and wood-burning stoves that are not self-fueled.
- **Ventilation:** A method of air distribution by air ducts to transfer air from one location to another. Air can be distributed passively or forced.
- **Air conditioning:** A system consisting of a cooling source and method of distribution designed to cool the surrounding air and area.

A permanently installed heating source may not be: –

1. A cooking appliance.
2. Portable space heaters.
3. Fireplaces or wood stoves.
4. This deficiency does not apply to:
 - a. Mechanical rooms or closets.
 - b. Hawaii, Puerto Rico, Guam, American Samoa, US Virgin Islands, Commonwealth of Northern Mariana Islands.

Inspection Procedure

- Determine exterior air temperature at the time of the inspection.
- Engage permanently installed heating source to verify functionality.
- For air conditioners, place a hand near the system or device to feel for conditioned air.
- If the heating system cannot be turned on due to design (e.g., system that is switched from a boiler to a chiller during the summer; a fuel-burning heating system that will not engage when the outside temperature is above a certain threshold), then do not evaluate under this deficiency.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	HVAC system is damaged/inoperable/missing (interior temp less than 64 degrees)	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
			Hours**	
8	Exhaust vent is misaligned, blocked, disconnected, or improperly connected	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
8	HVAC exhaust vent has a negative downward slope	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
8	HVAC exhaust vent is damaged or missing	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail

Heating, Ventilation, and Air Conditioning (HVAC) Standard V3.0 Updated 6/16/23

Heating, Ventilation, and Air Conditioning (HVAC) Standard V3.0 Updated 8/11/23

**HCV/PBV Repair Timeline for this standard is 30 days



A permanently installed heating source may not include space heaters that are not installed or fireplaces and wood stoves that are not self-fueled.

Revision: 15 — Last modified: 15 August 2023

8.8. Floor Drains

This standard refers to a sanitary drain opening on a floor in the common or public area and dwelling units. This can include a strainer, grate, covers, trap, and trap seal. This standard covers two conditions: When the drain is blocked as evidenced by standing water, or if a condition is observed that would prevent water from draining properly. These drains are typically found in mechanical rooms, laundry rooms, and restrooms.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Sanitary drain is fully blocked/obstructed	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

Floor Drain Standard Updated 6/23/22

Revision: 8 — Last modified: 18 June 2023

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	The Outside exit discharge is obstructed	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
1	Double-keyed cylinder present on any door	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
1	Egress door or windows does not fully open	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
1	Keyed window lock present on an egress window	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
1	Obstructed means of egress at a Unit's Entry Door	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	Double-keyed cylinder present on a bedroom door	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	Bedroom door or windows does not fully open	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	Keyed window lock present on a bedroom window	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	Permanent Air Conditioner in Bedroom Window	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	Sleeping Room (3rd Fl or Below) Obstructed Rescue Opening	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	Window or door requires a key or special knowledge to operate from the egress side	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	Window or door malfunctioning, preventing access to a means of egress	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	A door with moveable security bars requires a key to operate the lock	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
3	Fire escape access is obstructed	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail

Egress Standard Updated 6/16/23"

Egress Standard Updated 8/11/23"

Revision: 23 — Last modified: 10 November 2023

- a. The first instance of this deficiency during an inspection should be cited under Deficiency #5, subsequent instances cited under Deficiency #6.
4. Rats: Look in all areas where trash and food are prevalent for rat burrows, rat droppings (shiny, black, and 1/2 to 3/4 of an inch long), or chewed holes in exterior door sweeps or at the edges of outer doors (rat teeth are typically 1/8 inch long). Record a deficiency if a sticky pad or trap has a rat on it. Do not record a deficiency if there is a sticky pad or trap without a rat.
5. Other Pests: Look for evidence of other pests intruding on an interior area. Look for ant trails near food storage areas. Look for wasp nests and beehives present in an interior area. Look for evidence that squirrels, birds, or bats have penetrated the building covering and are nesting inside a building.

Inspection Instructions

To properly inspect for infestation, the inspector should use a flashlight and inspection mirror and examine areas commonly infested by insects and rodents. This includes all elements of a kitchen (cabinets, appliances, sinks), tops of doors in units, circuit breakers, outlets and switches, bathrooms, and all mechanical rooms. In bedrooms, areas around beds, along the headboard, and wall areas around the bed should be inspected for bedbugs with a flashlight.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Evidence of cockroaches (One Live Roach or Evidence of Infestation)	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	Extensive cockroach infestation (Live cockroaches in 2+ Locations in a Building)	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	Extensive cockroach infestation (Live cockroaches in 2+ Rooms in a Unit)	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
3	Evidence of bedbugs	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
4	Evidence of bedbugs in 2+ Rooms (Extensive)	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
4	Evidence of bedbugs in 2+ Locations (Extensive)	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
5	Evidence of mice	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
6	Evidence of mice in 2+ Rooms (Extensive)	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
6	Evidence of mice in 2+ Locations (Extensive)	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
7	Evidence of rats	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
8	Evidence of extensive rat infestation (One Live Rat Observed)	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
9	Evidence of other pests	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

fuel-burning water heater, should be recorded as a deficiency.

3. Petroleum products such as gasoline, kerosene, or propane should never be stored in a unit, even if not near an ignition source.
4. Any gas-powered equipment, including propane tanks, may be stored outside a unit and inside any storage room that is only accessible outside the building.
5. Excluding heating oil in a heating oil tank, petroleum products (e.g., gasoline, kerosene, or propane) should never be stored in the Unit or Inside areas.
 - a. A combustible item in its original container and stored in a safe place (e.g., under a kitchen sink, in a hall closet, etc.) is not a deficiency.
 - b. Electrical components should not be evaluated as ignition sources under this standard.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Combustible/Flammables material is on or within 3 feet of an HVAC appliance	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
1	Combustible/Flammables material is on or within 3 feet of a fuel burning Water Heater	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
1	Improperly Stored Chemicals (Paint, Gasoline, etc)	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail

Flammable and Combustible Item V3.0 Updated 6/16/23



This standard does not include an exception for flammable or combustible materials owned by a resident

Revision: 19 — Last modified: 19 June 2023

9.6. Lead Based Paint

For properties constructed before 1978, there is a possibility that paint on the interior or exterior of the building may contain lead. Lead-based paint (LBP) is paint or another surface coating that contains lead equal to or exceeding federal regulatory levels, currently 1.0 milligrams per square centimeter or 0.5 percent by weight. Deteriorated paint or surface coatings found in homes built before 1978 are LBP hazards if the paint is LBP. For this standard, if the property profile states that the property was constructed pre-1978, it is assumed that all painted structures were built pre-1978.

On the interior of the building (units and all common areas), any peeling paint should be assumed to have possible lead-based paint hazards.

1. For large Outside surfaces:
 - a. Look at painted exterior surface areas, including siding, fascia, soffit, trim, patios or decks, fencing, and any other large painted surfaces outside the building. Examine these areas for

9.7. Mold-Like Substances

This standard refers to moisture damage to interior surfaces. Under the NSPIRE standards, HUD refers to this as a "mold-like substance." A "mold-like substance" can include regular or irregular patches or spots on surfaces that may be colored differently than the surface (coloration can be white, green, yellow, gray, brown, or black) and can be raised from the surface.

- A "mold-like substance" can appear "fuzzy" or "cottony," and a musty or earthy odor can be associated with it.
- Detecting a musty or earthy odor alone is not to be recorded under this standard; visual observation of a "mold-like substance" is required.
- "Mold-like substance" would also include what is often identified as "mildew," i.e., small patches, generally on non-porous surfaces, and dusty (friable) when dry.
- Mildew is generally a thin surface growth that can be wiped off easily.
- Algae are not to be recorded (algae are grass-green).
- This deficiency is not recorded if observed on household items (e.g., clothing, upholstery, food

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Moisture damage on a surface from 4 Sq. In.to 1sf.(Units))	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
1	Moisture damage on a surface from 4 Sq. In. to 1 S.F.(Common Areas)	Low	60 Days	Pass
2	Moisture damage on a surface from 1 to 9 S.F. (Units)	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
2	Moisture damage on a surface from 1 to 9 S.F. (Common Areas)	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
3	Moisture damage on a surface more than 9 S.F. (Units)	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
3	Moisture damage on a surface more than 9 S.F. (Common Area)	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
4	Elevated moisture level in a unit	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
4	Elevated moisture level in a common area	Low	60 Days	Pass

**PBV/HCV Correction Timeframe is 30 Days for this Deficiency

Mold-Like Substance Standard V3.0 Updated 6/16/23"

Mold-Like Substance Standard V3.0 Updated 8/11/23"

10. Site and Grounds

Revision: 1 — Last modified: 3 April 2023

10.1. Address and Signage

Property signage includes signs near building entrances, either above or alongside the entrance or on a nearby post, as well as roadway entrances. This category can include large monument signs and any other signs that identify the location of the property, its name, or other relevant information. When inspecting the property's signage, a deficiency should be cited if the signage elements are broken, illegible, or not visible. Particular attention should be paid to the property's address on signage, which should be legible and visible. This can include the following conditions:

- The property address is obscured by vegetation or other object and is not legible,
- The property address is not legible due to physical damage.
- Site signage is physically damaged or broken.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Address, signage, or building identification codes are broken, illegible, or not visible	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

Address and Signage Standard V3 Updated 6.16.23

Address and Signage Standard V3 Updated 8.11.23

Revision: 10 — Last modified: 15 August 2023

10.2. Fences and Gates

Fences are only inspected if the fence, upright structure (e.g., solid wall), form a security perimeter. The type of fence does not impact the standards in any way. All security fences should be inspected to determine if the fence is leaning, components are missing and creating a hole of more than 20% of a single section, or if the gate on a fence is found to be inoperable or damaged. When inspecting a fence, check the fence posts and ensure that the posts do not have damage that would allow the fence or wall to become unstable, lean, or collapse.

- This item includes, but is not limited to, utility fencing, pool fencing, fencing around unprotected heights, storm water management pond, daycares, as well as associated gates. This item does not include non-security perimeter (i.e., intended to provide full or partial enclosure of a property along or near the property lines), landscape, or decorative fencing.

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Previously this deficiency included "fully enclosing an area of ground to mark a boundary and control

Revision: 11 — Last modified: 20 June 2023

10.4. Parking Lots

The parking lot standard is confined to two conditions: potholes and ponding water or ice affecting more than 5 percent of the parking area. For this standard, parking areas/lots include parking areas of all materials (gravel, dirt, pavers, asphalt) and include wheel stops and gravel.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Any one pothole is greater than 4" deep and 1 SF in area	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
2	Water or ice ponding more than 3" deep and affecting 5% of parking area	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

• Parking Lot Standard V3.0 Updated 6/16/23

Parking Lot Standard V3.0 Updated 8/11/23

Revision: 14 — Last modified: 15 August 2023

10.5. Private Roads and Driveways

This standard covers driveways and private roads of any material (asphalt, concrete, dirt, gravel, paving stones), expansion joints, curbing, gutters, utility access covers, and rebar. These areas are inspected for two deficiencies – potholes and significant obstructions. The pothole standard is the same as the parking area standard, utilizing two measurements to determine if a pothole is present.

Secondly, obstructions would include scenarios where the road is blocked or impassable, such as downed trees, impassable holes, large snowbanks, parked cars, or flooding that prevents the road or driveway from being accessed. This element can also include inoperable roadway gates but should not include temporary blocking, such as construction cones.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Road or driveway access to the property is blocked or impassable	Severe	24 Hours**	Fail
2	Any one pothole is greater than 4" deep and 1SF or Greater	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

**HCV/PBV Correction Timeframe is 30 Days for this deficiency

Private Roads and Driveways Standard V3.0 Updated 6/16/23"

Revision: 9 — Last modified: 18 June 2023

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Standing water is present above the outflow pipe entrance.	Low	60 Days	Pass
1	Drainage is blocked, and water is unable to drain properly	Low	60 Days	Pass
2	Ground erosion at a building's foundation that is 2' in depth and length or more	Low	60 Days	Pass
2	Erosion is present, and the footer is exposed.	Low	60 Days	Pass
3	Grate is not secure or does not cover the site drain opening	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

Site Drainage Standard V3.0 Updated 6/16/23*Revision: 12 — Last modified: 27 November 2023*



If signs of failure are present and cannot be attributed to a specific structural element, then evaluate under this standard.

Revision: 8 — Last modified: 18 June 2023

11.2. Roofing

Roofing is designed to protect the interior from exterior elements and collect and redirect the accumulation of precipitation from the roof surface to the ground or drainage system. Inspecting roofing elements can be performed on a flat roof by physically accessing the roof and examining the roofing membrane, associated components, and drains. The roofing surfaces have to be inspected to ensure that there is no damage to the roofing membrane, shingles, or any other materials such as gutters, downspouts, flashing, roofing ventilation, or soffit/fascia. The roofing material and associated components can be inspected from the ground for gabled roofs.

This standard has been divided into two categories

1. Roof Drains and Ponding
 - a. Gutters, Drains, and Downspouts
 - b. Ponding
2. Roof Assembly
 - a. Soffit, Fascia, Vents
 - b. Roof Surface
 - c. Roof Substrate

Roofing Standard V3.0 Updated 6/16/23

Revision: 7 — Last modified: 18 June 2023

11.2.1. Roof Drains and Ponding

Issues related to Roof Drains and Ponding include damaged gutters and drains, as well as standing water on the roofing.

1. Gutters and Downspouts
 - a. Buildings are not required to have gutters or downspouts
 - b. Any missing components on the building's gutters and downspouts should be cited

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Debris is limiting the ability of water to drain	Moderate	30 Days	Fail
1	25 SF +/- ponding water above/around a roof drain	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

11.3. Fire Escapes

A fire escape is an apparatus on the outside of a building used for fleeing a building on fire, providing a means of alternative emergency egress from the interior of the building to the exterior. Fire escapes can be stairs, a ladder, a counterbalanced stairway, or a drop ladder.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Any stair, ladder, platform, guardrail, or handrail is damaged	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
1	Any stair, ladder, platform, guardrail, or handrail is missing	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail

Fire Escape Standard V3.0 Updated 6/16/23

* If a window, door leading to the fire escape, or the fire escape itself is blocked, refer to the Egress standard.

Revision: 8 — Last modified: 18 June 2023

11.4. Exterior Wall Coverings

The building's wall covering refers to any material on the building envelope regardless of age, type of construction, or use and purpose of the structure. The standards for building wall coverings relate to the essential function of exterior walls: to provide security and prevent moisture from entering the building. The basic standards include the following:

1. Missing sections greater than a square foot.
2. Holes in the exterior wall that penetrate the wall and create the possibility for water infiltration
3. Peeling paint on any one wall that exceeds 10 square feet.
4. Damage to the building's exterior walls that can result in serious structural failure, which includes:
 - a. Cracked masonry walls or warped wooden siding.
 - b. Signs of deterioration of the vertical load (e.g., wall buckling or bowing).
 - c. Window or door that is out of plumb and does not fit into the frame.
 - d. Large holes in the exterior wall.
 - e. Any rotting or deteriorating columns.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Exterior wall with missing section greater than 12x12"	Moderate	30 Days	Fail

Foundation Standard V3.0 Updated June 16, 2023

Foundation Standard V3.0 Updated August 11, 2023

Revision: 13 --- Last modified: 27 November 2023

11.6. Chimneys

This standard refers to a visible chimney extending from a fireplace or wood-burning appliance or any building that conveys combustion exhaust to the exterior. The following conditions are inspected under this standard:

1. A damaged chimney or missing elements and its ability to function as intended are affected.
2. Structural damage to a chimney. Examples of structural chimney failure include, but are not limited to:
 - Misalignment or detachment.
 - Leaning away from the building.
 - Collapsed or in imminent danger of collapse.
 - Holes
 - Bricks that are damaged, missing, or cracked such that smoke or combustion gases may not vent as intended
 - Failed lining (e.g., creosote leaching through brick).
 - For the purpose of this inspection, the ash cleanout should be considered as part of the firebox and therefore evaluated under this deficiency.

Def#	Deficiency	Severity	Repair Due	HCV Rating
1	Wood burning fireplace/appliance chimney is incomplete	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
1	Wood burning fireplace/appliance chimney is damaged	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
1	Failed lining (e.g., creosote leaching through brick)	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail
2	Chimney shows signs of structural failure on exterior of building	Life Threatening	24 Hours	Fail



Ventilation on fuel-burning appliances (boilers, water heaters, etc.) should be inspected under HVAC or Water Heaters.

Chimney Standard V3.0 Updated 6/16/23